

Do discounts increase sales?

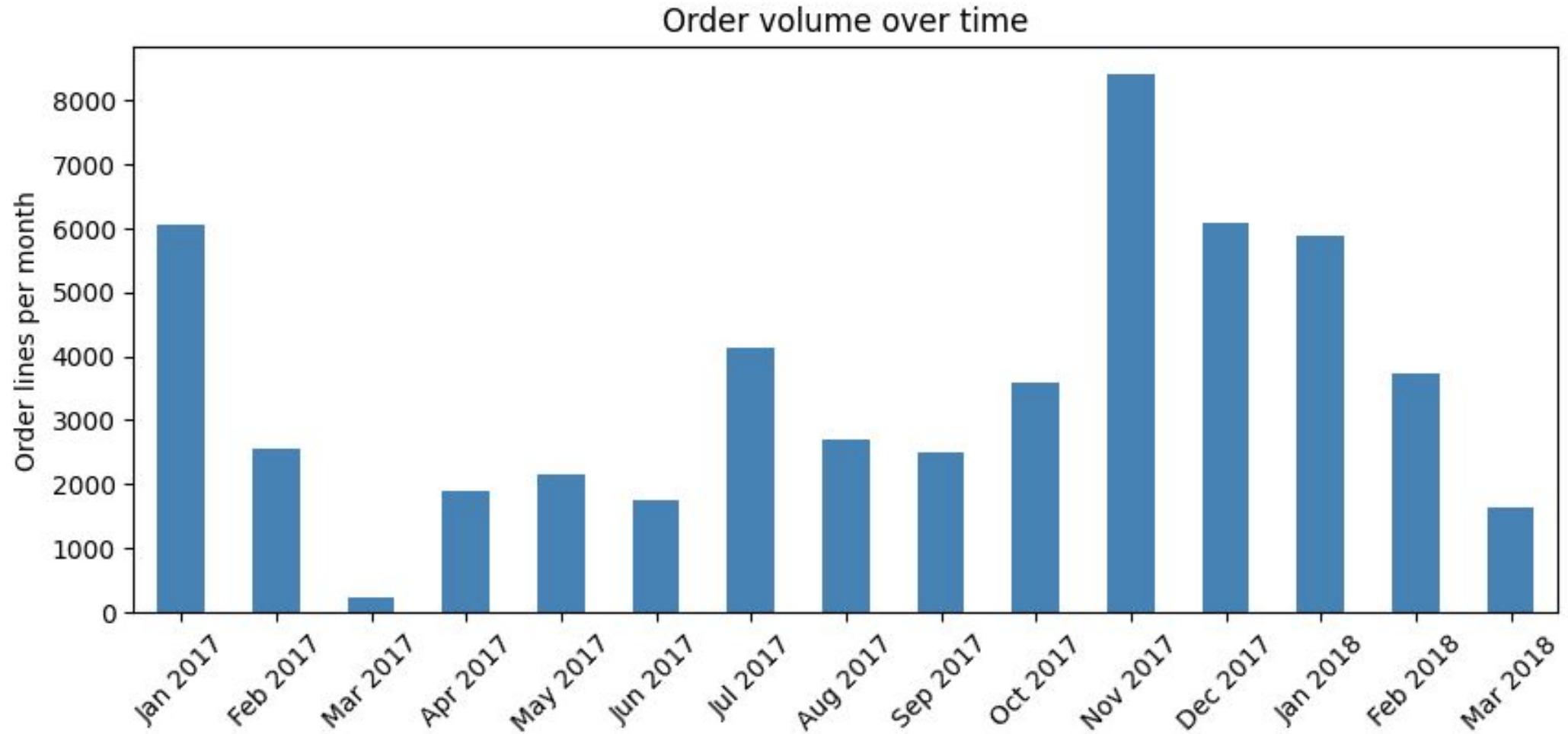
An observational analysis of 53,231 sold positions

JAN 2017 — MAR 2018

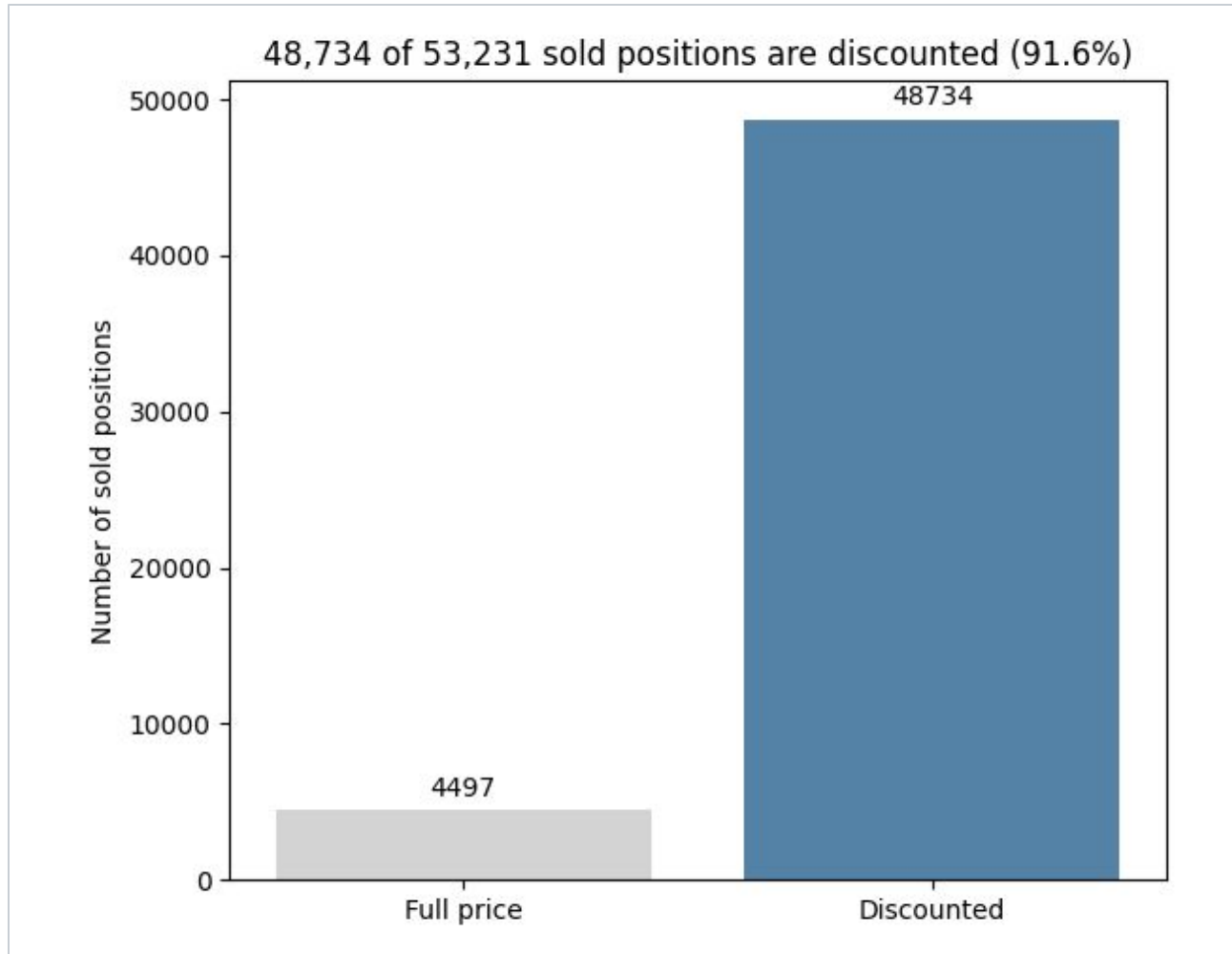
-0.002

correlation between average
discount and units sold

Sales volume is driven by a few seasonal peaks



Discounting is the default, not an exception



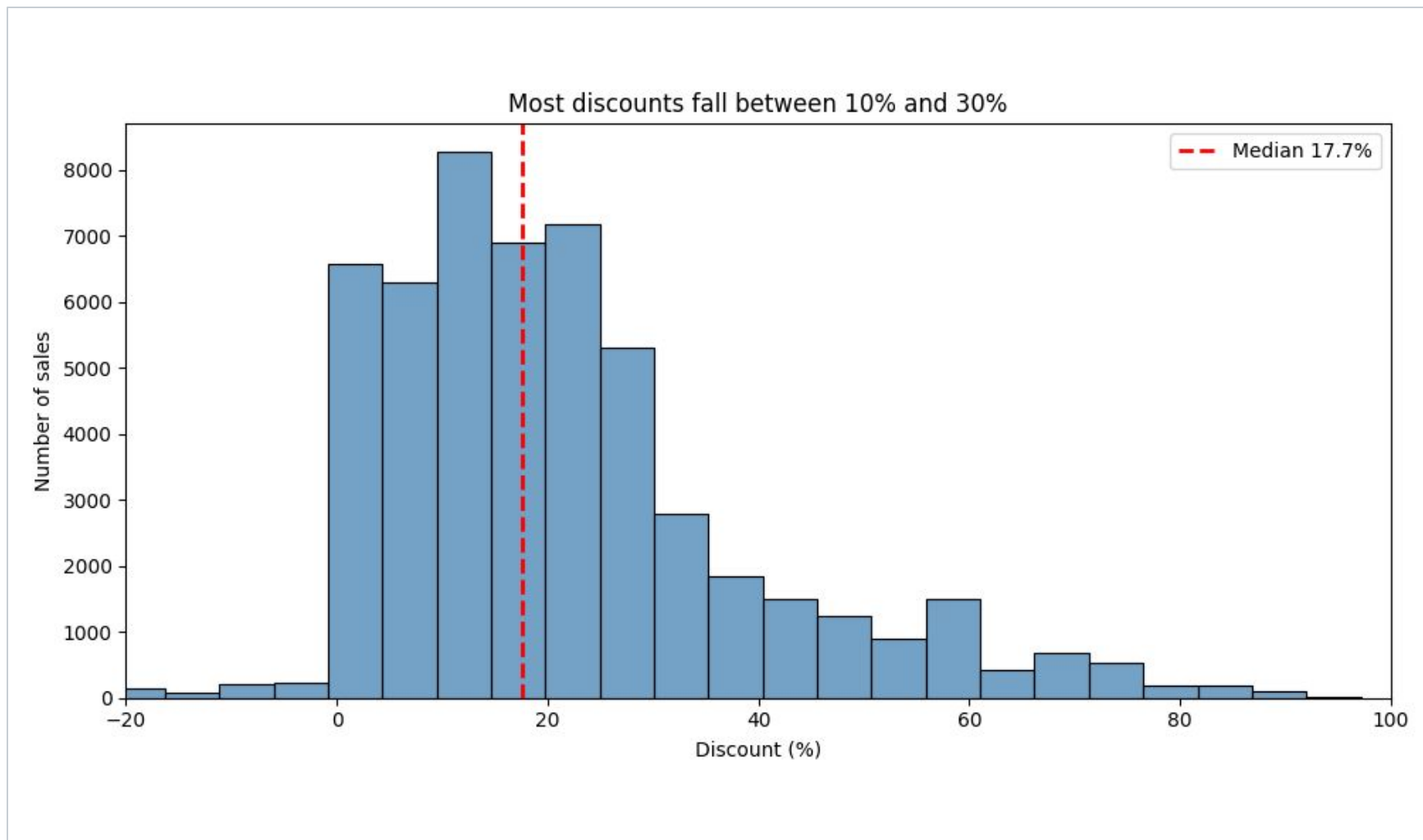
91.6%

of all sold positions were discounted

48,734

discounted positions out of 53,231

Eniac operates at a permanent ~20% below list price



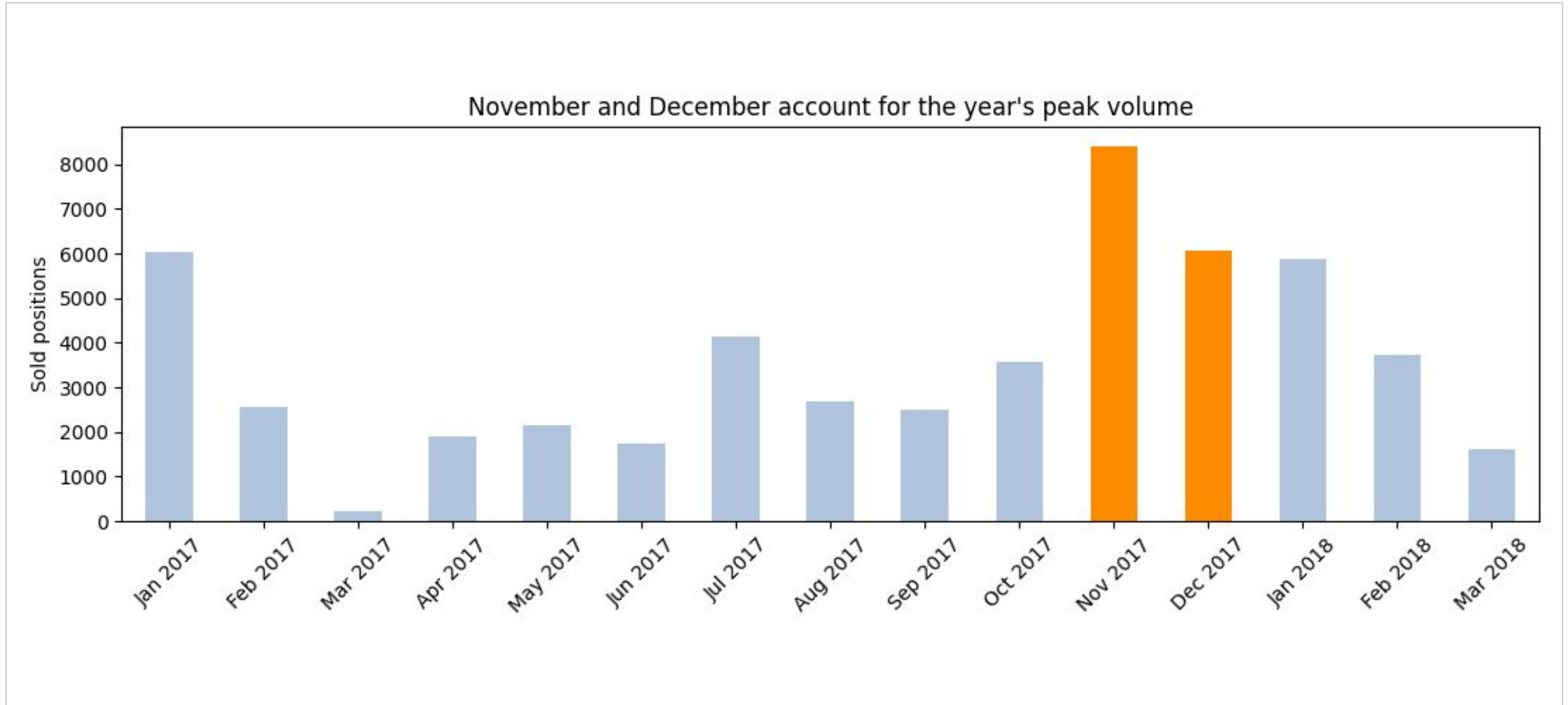
17.7%

median discount

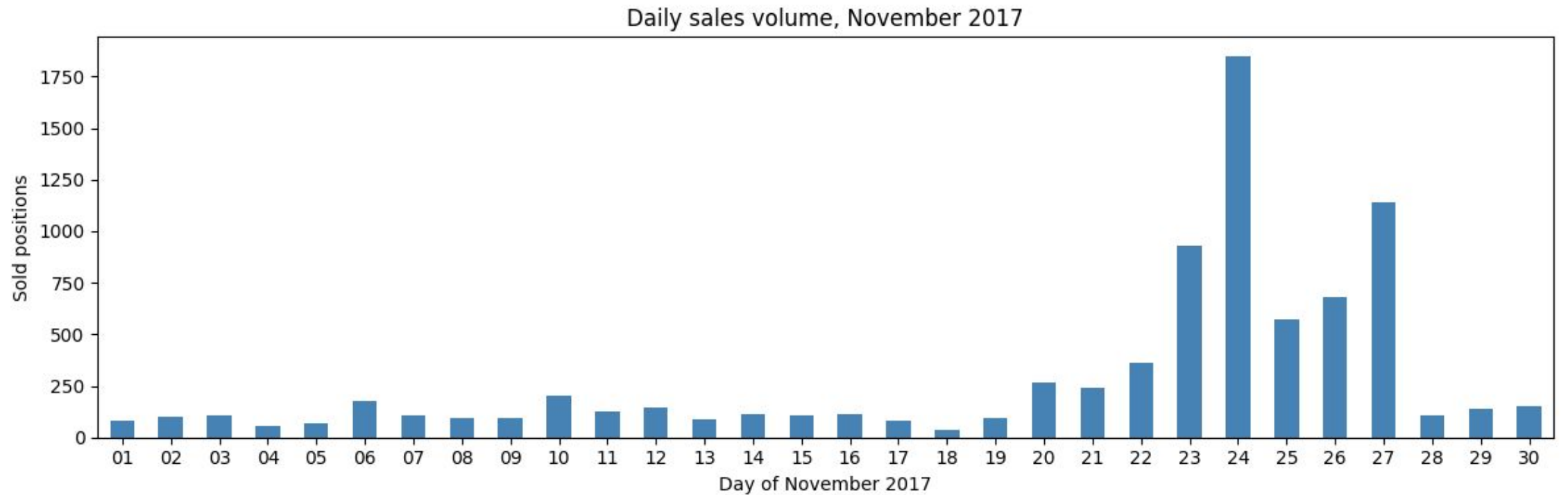
9–29%

middle half of sales

November and December carry the year's peak volume

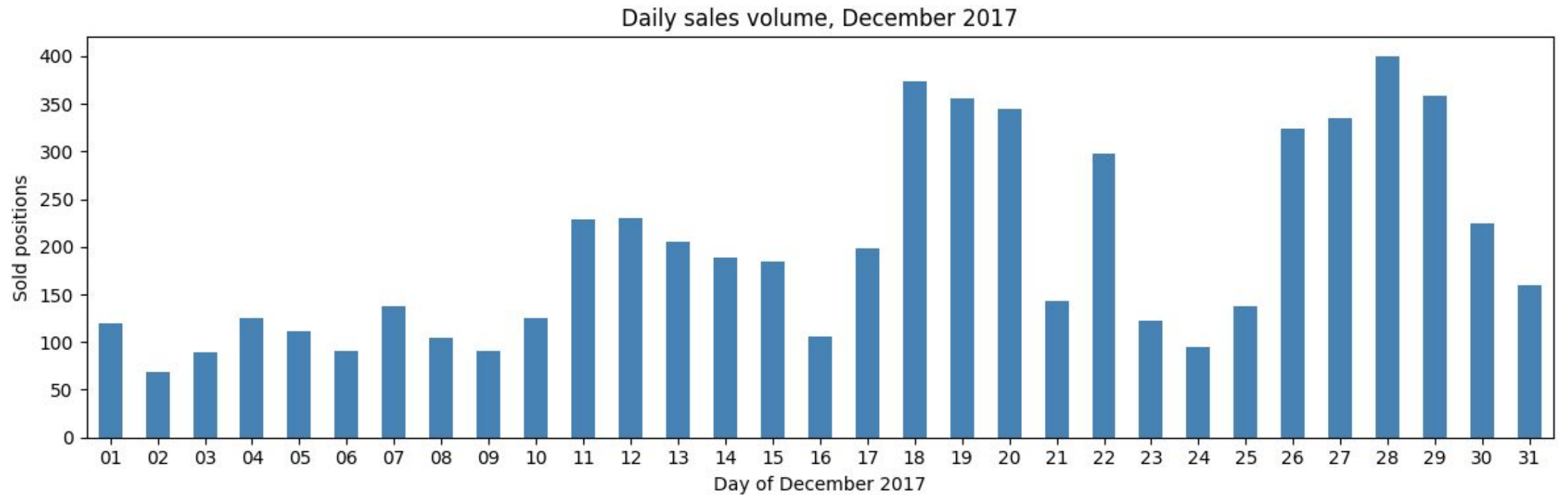


Black Friday creates the sharpest demand spike



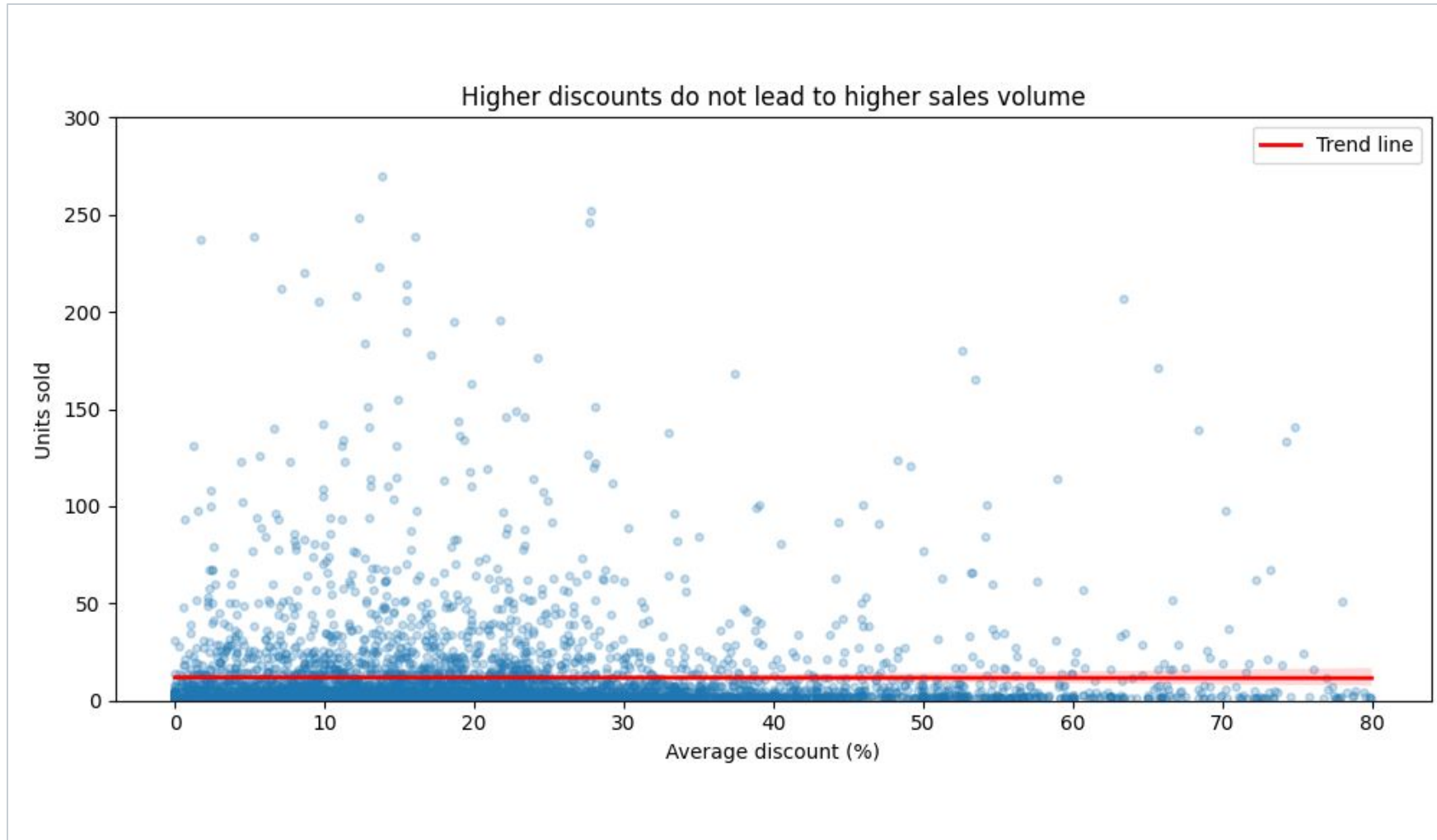
24 NOV · 1,849 sold positions

The December peak occurs after Christmas



28 DEC · strongest December day

Higher discounts do not increase sales volume

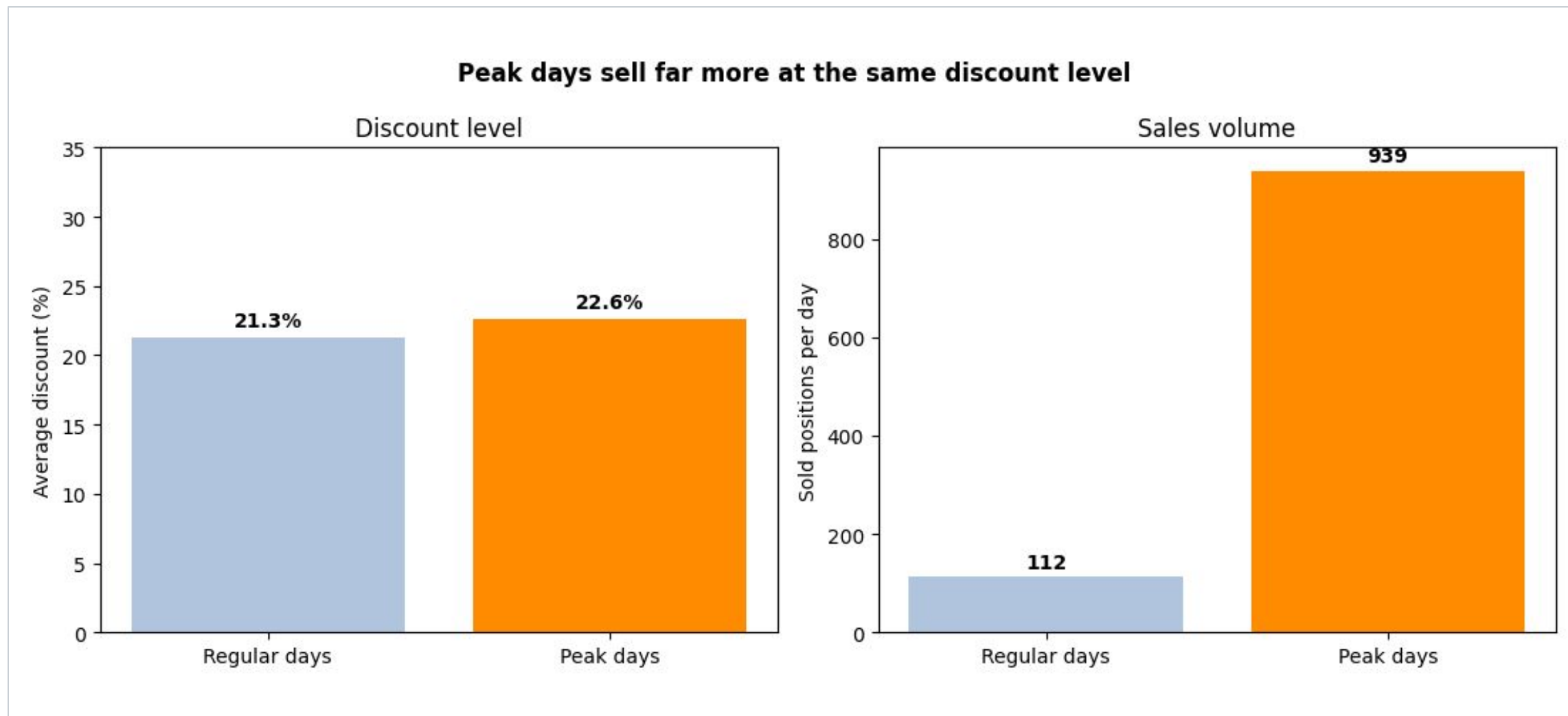


-0.002

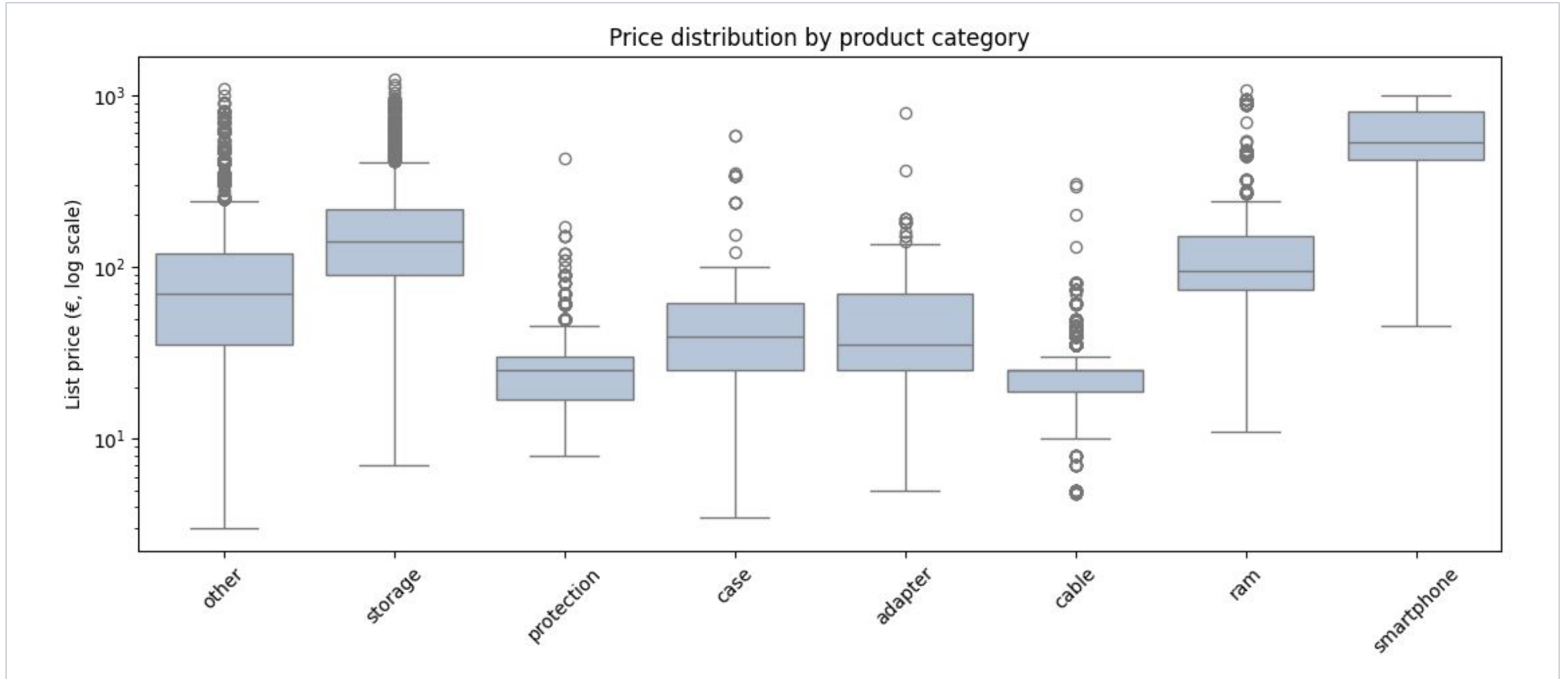
correlation:
effectively no
relationship

**Observational data:
no causal control
group**

Peak days sell 8.4× more at nearly the same discount



List-price structure differs sharply by product category



Category context does not explain a general discount effect.

Broad, permanent discounts are not supported by the data

91.6%

Discount coverage leaves no meaningful control group.

-0.002

Discount depth has no measurable relationship with units sold.

8.4×

Peak-day volume rises while discount levels remain nearly unchanged.

RECOMMENDATION

Replace blanket year-round discounting with controlled product-level tests.